

## Chapter 24-5

"If you have something to ask, go ahead and say it."

"What's your relationship with Boss Yan? How is she, and how are you..." Kong Murui's face was filled with confusion.

Yin Lingzhu didn't look at her, but turned toward Wan Miayin. "Wife-wife relationship<sup>1</sup>. Currently, we're preparing for divorce."

"Then how did I hear her say she wants to have a child with you?" Kong Murui was somewhat disbelieving.

"Perhaps big shots all have something wrong with their brains. Who knows what she's thinking." Yin Lingzhu said dismissively.

Kong Murui wanted to ask more, but was grabbed and pulled away by Wan Miayin.

"It's already evening now. Zhuzi<sup>2</sup> spent the whole day out and must be tired. Let her rest."

Seeing Wan Miayin drag Kong Murui away, Yin Lingzhu didn't say much more.

She took out her phone and started chatting with Ji Jingrong again.

Near the end of their conversation, Ji Jingrong suddenly asked about the small fish. Yin Lingzhu hesitated for a moment.

【The boss took them away.】

Ji Jingrong's reply came very quickly.

【What a pity. You caught that fish yourself. If I had known, I would have taken it when you offered to give it to me.】

Seeing her message, Yin Lingzhu was amused.

【How are you saying it as if I personally went into the water to fish? I just spent ten yuan using that palm-sized paper net to scoop them out of a small basin.】

【You have a cat at home and work. You couldn't take care of fish anyway.】

They chatted for a while longer until Yin Lingzhu's phone died, ending their conversation.

Yan Si put the small goldfish in a newly bought large fish tank—a tank that was 1.8 meters long and 1 meter high, housing two small fish that were only ten centimeters long.

Yan Si sprinkled some fish food into the tank and installed an oxygen pump before leaving with peace of mind.

You Xiaoxiao looked at Yan Si lying on the hospital bed, her face full of worry.

The doctor performing surgery on Yan Si was acquainted with You Xiaoxiao. Seeing You Xiaoxiao's worried expression, she said:

"Don't worry. The surgery isn't life-threatening. At most it won't succeed. Don't worry."

"Besides, she and the embryo donor have had so many markings<sup>3</sup>. Theoretically, her body is already prepared for acceptance. Don't worry."

The doctor patted her shoulder, signaling her to leave the operating room.

You Xiaoxiao looked at Yan Si with concern, leaving with reluctant backward glances.

Outside, she recalled the doctor's words but still couldn't feel at ease.

She knew everything the doctor had said, but Yan Si's gland was severely damaged, so conception would likely be difficult.

She was afraid Yan Si would keep having surgeries until she finally conceived.

You Xiaoxiao waited outside the operating room. The soundproofing was very good—she couldn't hear any movement from inside.

You Xiaoxiao didn't know how long she waited before finally seeing the doctor come out.

"How did it go?"

The doctor shook her head. "Unsuccessful."

You Xiaoxiao wasn't surprised by this result.

She had known before the surgery that Yan Si's chances of success on the first attempt weren't high.

Yan Si had already been moved from the operating room to a hospital room. You Xiaoxiao wanted to comfort her but didn't know how to begin.

Yan Si noticed her hesitation.

"If the first time doesn't succeed, then there's a second time. If the second doesn't succeed, there's a third. Eventually it will succeed." Yan Si said weakly, feeling the pain in her body.

You Xiaoxiao couldn't bear to see her like this.

"She's not worth you doing this." You Xiaoxiao said angrily.

Yan Si turned her head toward the window, not looking at her. "I think it's very worth it."

"If I can use a child to gain her attention, it's very worth it."

Yan Si felt she couldn't even lift her hands. The pain seemed to crawl out from her very bones.

"Back then, when I extracted her pheromones, was she also in this much pain?"

You Xiaoxiao heard what Yan Si said clearly and began to recall that moment.

"It should have been quite painful. She seemed to have fainted from the pain."

Tears flowed from Yan Si's eyes down to her hair. Only now did she realize how terribly wrong she had been.

Yin Lingzhu suddenly felt uneasy in her heart. She couldn't help but think of Yan Si—could she really have gone through with the surgery?

Before, Yin Lingzhu would have immediately dismissed this idea, but now she was somewhat uncertain.

She hadn't known before that Yan Si could be this crazy.

Yin Lingzhu saw her phone light up, showing You Xiaoxiao's phone number.

After answering, she heard You Xiaoxiao's anxious voice through the receiver.

"Yin Lingzhu, come quickly and persuade Yan Si. She's determined to have your child."

Yin Lingzhu had wanted to say that this was Yan Si's own stubbornness and had nothing to do with her.

But You Xiaoxiao's next words negated this thought.

"If Yan Si really has your child, wouldn't divorcing become extremely difficult?"

After thinking it over, Yin Lingzhu realized this was true.

"Alright, send me the hospital address. I'll come right away." Yin Lingzhu grabbed a jacket and hurried to the hospital.

When Yan Si saw her arrive, a smile hadn't yet had time to appear on her face before her gaze fell on Yin Lingzhu, and her expression suddenly darkened.

"Whose jacket are you wearing?"

Hearing Yan Si's questioning tone, Yin Lingzhu instinctively looked down at herself.

She was wearing Wan Miayin's clothes.

Realizing this, she immediately took off the jacket.

Seeing her action, Yan Si's smile bloomed again on her face.

"Besides not wanting to divorce, do you have any other reason for insisting on this child?" Yin Lingzhu took off the jacket and sat beside her.

Yan Si shook her head. "No."

"Then if I agreed not to divorce, would you be able to give up this idea?"

Yan Si hesitated for a moment, then nodded.

You Xiaoxiao saw Yan Si's attitude soften and silently urged Yin Lingzhu to press harder.

"But even if you give birth to this child, I will still divorce you."

"This is something that cannot be changed." Yin Lingzhu's words still stunned both people present.

Yin Lingzhu looked at Yan Si. "Let's not play this ridiculous game anymore."

"Only children think like 'you hit me once, I hit you once, then we're even.'"

Looking at Yan Si on the hospital bed, Yin Lingzhu felt somewhat reluctant.

She closed her eyes. "Yan Si, stop these self-moving theatrics."

"Taking it to the extreme, even if I believed you loved me, we're still finished."

You Xiaoxiao looked at Yin Lingzhu's profile, listening to her words, feeling something was increasingly wrong.

Finally, she forcibly covered Yin Lingzhu's mouth.

Yin Lingzhu didn't struggle, letting her cover it.

She had already said everything that needed to be said. Now it was up to how Yan Si would think about it.

Yin Lingzhu also knew that if she said she wouldn't divorce, Yan Si would definitely stop the surgery.

But she was unwilling. Why should she fabricate a lie to appease Yan Si? It wouldn't benefit her either.

Yin Lingzhu's heart was especially hard at this moment.

If her heart didn't become a bit more ruthless, she would never be able to leave Yan Si in this lifetime.

Yan Si's mind kept cycling through Yin Lingzhu's words. It turned out some words could be more terrifying than knives.

They slowly drilled into a person's heart, scraping at Yan Si's heart one cut at a time.

Yan Si felt her heart sinking. Lying on the hospital bed, she couldn't tell whether her heart hurt more or her body hurt more.

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## Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> Wife-wife relationship: In Chinese, "妻妻關係" literally means "wife-wife relationship," indicating a same-sex marriage between two women.

<sup>2</sup> Zhuzi: A nickname for Yin Lingzhu, with "竹" (zhu) meaning "bamboo"—a shortened, affectionate form of her name.

<sup>3</sup> Markings: In omegaverse/ABO fiction, "marking" refers to when an Alpha bites an Omega's scent glands to create a bond. Multiple markings would theoretically prepare the body for accepting the Alpha's genetic material.